12-21 第二篇

The Diversity of World Languages

There are roughly 7,000 languages spoken in the world today. Each one carries its own way of expressing ideas, telling stories, and connecting people. Languages shape how we see the world—some have many words for colors or snow, while others structure time and relationships differently. This diversity is a treasure of human culture, but it is also under threat. About half of the world's languages are endangered, with fewer and fewer young people learning them. [1]

Languages are lost when communities shift to dominant languages like English, Mandarin, or Spanish for work, education, or daily life. When the last fluent speakers of a language die, the language often dies with them. Lost languages take with them unique knowledge—about local plants, traditional medicine, history, and ways of thinking that may not exist elsewhere. Once gone, that knowledge is extremely hard to recover. [2]

Efforts to preserve languages are growing. Some communities run language schools or immersion programs where children learn their ancestral tongue. Technology helps too—recordings, dictionaries, and apps can store and teach languages even when few speakers remain. Linguists work with communities to document grammar, vocabulary, and stories before they disappear. International organizations support projects that promote multilingual education and respect for linguistic heritage. [3]

Learning another language opens doors. It allows you to communicate with more people, understand different cultures, and sometimes think in new ways. Schools that teach multiple languages give students tools for a connected world. At the same time, keeping mother tongues alive at home and in the community helps maintain identity and pass traditions to the next generation. [4]

The world's languages are a living record of human creativity and resilience. Protecting them is not only about saving words—it is about honoring the people and cultures that created them. [5]

选项

A. Language diversity reflects the richness of human experience, but it requires active effort to maintain. B. When a language disappears, we lose more than words; we lose a unique window into human thought and culture. C. These combined efforts offer hope that more languages can be saved and passed on to future generations. D. In this way, both learning new languages and preserving home languages contribute to a more diverse and connected world. E. Valuing every language, no matter how small, is a step toward a world that respects all its people and their heritage. F. For example, the Maori

language of New Zealand has seen a revival through schools, media, and government support over recent decades.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前说世界约7000种语言、每种承载独特表达方式、语言塑造世界观、多样性是文化宝藏但受威胁、约半数为濒危语言、越来越少年轻人学习，空后需总结多样性的价值与维护需求。A的"reflects the richness of human experience"与"treasure of human culture"呼应，"requires active effort to maintain"与前文对应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说语言在社区转为工作教育生活用 dominant 语言时流失、最后流利者去世语言常随之消失、流失语言带走独特知识如当地植物传统医药历史思维、一旦消失难以恢复，空后需总结语言消失的损失。B的"When a language disappears"承接前文，"we lose more than words; we lose a unique window into human thought and culture"与前文对应。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说保护努力在增长、社区办语言学校或沉浸项目、技术帮助如录音字典应用、语言学家与社区合作记录、国际组织支持多语教育与尊重语言遗产，空后需总结综合努力带来的希望。C的"These combined efforts"指代前文，"offer hope that more languages can be saved"与前文呼应。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说学另一门语言打开大门、与更多人交流理解不同文化、学校教多语给学生工具、同时在家和社区保持母语有助于身份认同与传承，空后需总结学新语言与保母语的双重贡献。D的"In this way"承接前文，"both learning new languages and preserving home languages contribute to a more diverse and connected world"与前文对应。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前说世界语言是人类创造力与韧性的活记录、保护它们不仅是保存词汇、更是尊重创造它们的人与文化，空后需总结重视每种语言的意义。E的"Valuing every language, no matter how small"与前文呼应，"step toward a world that respects all its people and their heritage"与前文对应。

- **干扰项分析**：
    - **F. For example, the Maori language of New Zealand has seen...**：以For example开头，为具体语言复兴案例（毛利语）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[3]易被误选因涉及保护努力，但该空需总结综合努力的希望，而非补充某语言复兴的细节。